

RELIGIOUS EXPERIENCE: NATURE AND OBJECT

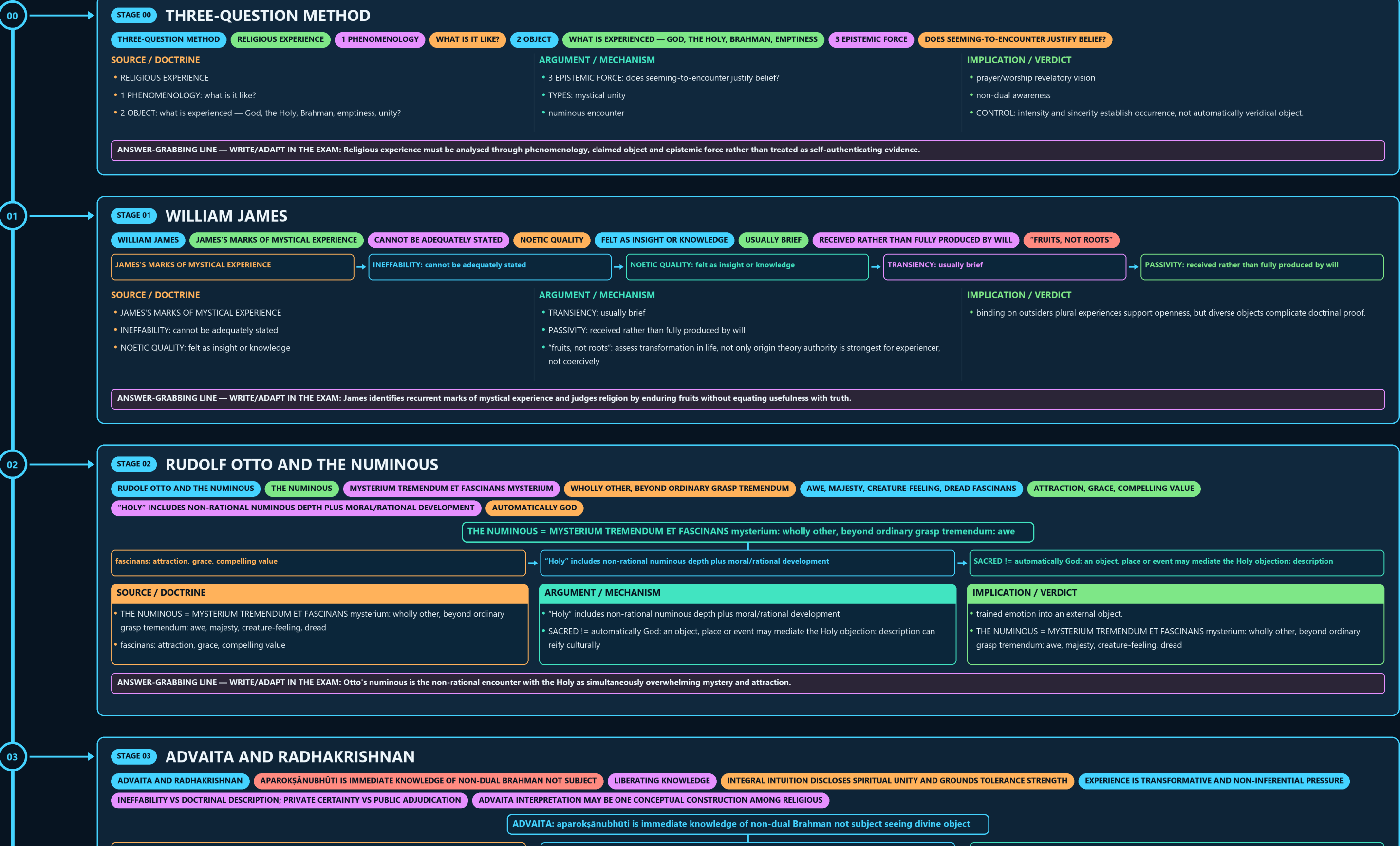
THREE-QUESTION METHOD → WILLIAM JAMES → RUDOLF OTTO AND THE → ADVAITA AND RADHAKRISHNAN → OBJECT MODELS → VERIDICALITY TESTS

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g12 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



- trained emotion into an external object.
- THE NUMINOUS = MYSTERIUM TREMENDUM ET FASCINANS mysterium: wholly other, beyond ordinary grasp tremendum: awe, majesty, creature-feeling, dread

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM:** Otto's numinous is the non-rational encounter with the Holy as simultaneously overwhelming mystery and attraction.

STAGE 03 ADVAITA AND RADHAKRISHNAN

**EXPERIENCE IS TRANSFORMATIVE AND NON-INFERENTIAL PRESSURE**

**ADVAITA INTERPRETATION MAY BE ONE CONCEPTUAL CONSTRUCTION AMONG RELIGIOUS**

**ADVAITA: aparokṣānubhūti is immediate knowledge of non-dual Brahman not subject seeing divine object**

subject-object division is sublated śravaṇa → manana → nididhyāsana → liberating knowledge

► **RADHAKRISHNAN:** integral intuition discloses spiritual unity and grounds tolerance strength: experience is transformative and non-inferential

private certainty vs public adjudication

**SOURCE / DOCTRINE**

- ADVAITA: aparokṣānubhūti is immediate knowledge of non-dual Brahman not subject seeing divine object
- subject-object division is sublated śravaṇa → manana → nididhyāsana → liberating knowledge

**ARGUMENT / MECHANISM**

- RADHAKRISHNAN: integral intuition discloses spiritual unity and grounds tolerance strength: experience is transformative and non-inferential pressure: ineffability vs
- private certainty vs public adjudication

## IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- Advaita interpretation may be one conceptual construction among religious traditions.
- ADVAITA: aparokṣānubhūti is immediate knowledge of non-dual Brahman not subject seeing divine object

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM:** Advaita interprets non-dual awareness as Brahman-realisation, while Radhakrishnan prioritises spiritual intuition over later doctrinal expression.

## STAGE 04 OBJECT MODELS

**BUDDHISM EMPTINESS, CESSATION OR SUCHNESS WITHOUT CREATOR NATURALISM ALTERED**

**OBJECT-CLAIM NEEDS INTERPRETATION BEYOND RAW IMMEDIACY.**

| SYSTEM / DOCTRINE                                                                                                                             | DECISIVE DISTINCTION                                                                                                                                                  | EVALUATION / TRAP                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| MODEL WHAT EXPERIENCE PRESENTS personal theism an addressive "Thou," grace, command, presence                                                 | Advaita non-dual Brahman; no final subject-object split                                                                                                               | SAME phenomenological report may underdetermine ontology                                                 |
| Otto numinous Holy / wholly other                                                                                                             | Buddhism emptiness, cessation or suchness without creator naturalism altered brain/body state interpreted religiously                                                 | object-claim needs interpretation beyond raw immediacy.                                                  |
| SYSTEM / DOCTRINE                                                                                                                             | DECISIVE DISTINCTION                                                                                                                                                  | EVALUATION / TRAP                                                                                        |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>MODEL WHAT EXPERIENCE PRESENTS personal theism an addressive "Thou," grace, command, presence</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Advaita non-dual Brahman; no final subject-object split</li></ul>                                                               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>SAME phenomenological report may underdetermine ontology</li></ul> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Otto numinous Holy / wholly other</li></ul>                                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Buddhism emptiness, cessation or suchness without creator naturalism altered brain/body state interpreted religiously</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>object-claim needs interpretation beyond raw immediacy.</li></ul>  |

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM:** The sacred, the Holy, God and the Absolute are competing object-models, not interchangeable names for one uncontested referent.

## STAGE 05 VERIDICALITY TESTS

**MORAL FRUIT**

**SWINBURNE PRINCIPLE OF CREDULITY: accept seeming appearance unless defeated**

**PRINCIPLE OF TESTIMONY:** generally trust reports unless there is reason not to

**DEFEATERS: drugs/pathology**

prior implausibility

unreliable setting positive checks: coherence

## SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SWINBURNE PRINCIPLE OF CREDULITY: accept seeming appearance unless defeated
- PRINCIPLE OF TESTIMONY: generally trust reports unless there is reason not to
- DEFEATERS: drugs/pathology
- prior implausibility

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- unreliable setting positive checks: coherence
- moral fruit
- intersubjective fit
- predictive/explanatory value

## IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- ALSTON: socially established doxastic practice may confer prima facie justification objection: incompatible religious practices cannot all validate exclusive
- objects unchanged.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM:** Perception-like religious experience may have prima facie force, but diversity, pathology and counterevidence can function as defeaters.

## STAGE 06 CRITICISMS, REPLIES AND PUBLIC LIFE

SWINBURNE PRINCIPLE OF CREDULITY: accept seeming appearance unless defeated

→

PRINCIPLE OF TESTIMONY: generally trust reports unless there is reason not to

→

DEFEATERS: drugs/pathology

→

prior implausibility

→

unreliable setting positive checks: coherence

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SWINBURNE PRINCIPLE OF CREDULITY: accept seeming appearance unless defeated
- PRINCIPLE OF TESTIMONY: generally trust reports unless there is reason not to
- DEFEATERS: drugs/pathology
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ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- unreliable setting positive checks: coherence
- moral fruit
- intersubjective fit
- predictive/explanatory value

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- ALSTON: socially established doxastic practice may confer prima facie justification objection: incompatible religious practices cannot all validate exclusive
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Perception-like religious experience may have prima facie force, but diversity, pathology and counterevidence can function as defeaters.

06

STAGE 06

CRITICISMS, REPLIES AND PUBLIC LIFE

CRITICISMS, REPLIES AND PUBLIC LIFE

SOCIAL CONSOLATION

NEURAL CORRELATE PLURALISM

CONTRADICTIONARY INTERPRETATIONS

NO COMMUNICABLE EVIDENCE REPLIES

CAUSAL EXPLANATION DOES NOT EQUAL DEBUNKING; ALL PERCEPTION HAS

FRUITS AND DISCIPLINED PRACTICES MAY DISTINGUISH MATURE EXPERIENCE FROM

PETITION, GRATITUDE, SURRENDER, CONTEMPLATION PUBLIC USE MUST BE MODEST

FREUD: wish-fulfilment

MARX: social consolation

→

neuroscience: neural correlate pluralism: contradictory interpretations

→

ineffability: no communicable evidence replies: causal explanation does not equal debunking; all perception has neural

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- FREUD: wish-fulfilment
- MARX: social consolation

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- neuroscience: neural correlate pluralism: contradictory interpretations
- ineffability: no communicable evidence replies: causal explanation does not equal debunking; all perception has neural correlates

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- fruits and disciplined practices may distinguish mature experience from fantasy prayer/worship test object-relations: petition, gratitude, surrender, contemplation public
- use must be modest: experience may justify commitment without authorising coercion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Prayer addresses the ultimate, worship enacts supreme worth, and public justification must translate private experience into shareable reasons.

07

STAGE 07

PYQ ANSWER SPINE

PYQ ANSWER SPINE

DEFINE TYPE

DESCRIBE PHENOMENOLOGY WITH JAMES/OTTO

SPECIFY CLAIMED OBJECT

DISTINGUISH EXPERIENCE FROM INTERPRETATION

APPLY CREDULITY/TESTIMONY AND DEFEATERS

COMPARE ADVAITA/THEISM/BUDDHISM

STRONGEST NATURALIST OR PLURALIST OBJECTION

DEFINE type — describe phenomenology with James/Otto — specify claimed object

→

distinguish experience from interpretation — apply credulity/testimony and defeaters

→

compare Advaita/theism/Buddhism — strongest naturalist or pluralist objection

→

reply — qualified public verdict

→

CLOSE: religious experience is significant evidence within a life and practice, but its object is

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DEFINE type → describe phenomenology with James/Otto → specify claimed object
- distinguish experience from interpretation → apply credulity/testimony and defeaters

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- compare Advaita/theism/Buddhism → strongest naturalist or pluralist objection
- reply → qualified public verdict

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- CLOSE: religious experience is significant evidence within a life and practice, but its object is not read straight off the feeling
- interpretation and defeater control remain.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Public philosophical use of religious experience requires a distinction between sincere testimony, transformative fruit and metaphysical proof.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

ADVANCED-DOSSIER RECONCILIATION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

DOCTRINE STATEMENT.

MYSTICAL STATES ARE MARKED BY INEFFABILITY AND NOETIC QUALITY

THEIR AUTHORITY IS STRONGEST FOR THE SUBJECT AND TESTED

JAMES GATHERS FIRST-PERSON REPORTS, IDENTIFIES RECURRENT PHENOMENOLOGICAL FEATURES, AND

PRESUPPOSITION. CAUTION

FIRST-PERSON TESTIMONY IS LEGITIMATE DATA AND PRAGMATIC TRANSFORMATION IS

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- Advanced-dossier reconciliation — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- Doctrine statement.
- Mystical states are marked by ineffability and noetic quality, with transiency and passivity as usual additional marks
- their authority is strongest for the subject and tested pragmatically by fruits.

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- Argument.
- James gathers first-person reports, identifies recurrent phenomenological features, and refuses to reduce their value to pathological origins because
- Presupposition. CAUTION: First-person testimony is legitimate data and pragmatic transformation is evidentially relevant.
- Distinction. Noetic quality means experienced insight, not independently demonstrated knowledge.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Canonical example. Conversion reorganises a divided self and is assessed through enduring moral integration.
- Objection → reply.
- CAUTION: Private certainty cannot establish a public object.
- James restricts coercive authority: the experience may rationally authorise the experiencer without binding outsiders.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels

RELIGIOUS EXPERIENCE: NATURE AND OBJECT • TILE 3/3 • same master rows 4958-8192 of 8192 • end